

OSINT INVESTIGATION REPORT

Subject: OpenAI

Prepared using only publicly available information

Analyst	Akhila
Team	Intelligence Accuracy / OSINT Track — Day 1 Practical
Date	July 3, 2026
Classification	Public Sources Only (OSINT)
Subject HQ	1455 3rd Street, San Francisco, CA 94158

1. Executive Summary

OpenAI is a San Francisco-based artificial intelligence company, founded in 2015, best known for ChatGPT and its API platform. As of mid-2026, the company has completed one of the largest private financing rounds in history, reports roughly \$2 billion in monthly revenue, and has filed confidentially for an IPO with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission. The company operates under a hybrid nonprofit/public-benefit-corporation structure, has experienced several rounds of leadership turnover, and continues to face legal and reputational scrutiny alongside its rapid commercial growth.

2. Company Overview

OpenAI was founded in 2015. Its founding team, per public records, included:

- Sam Altman (CEO)
- Greg Brockman
- Ilya Sutskever
- Elon Musk
- John Schulman
- Andrej Karpathy
- Trevor Blackwell, Wojciech Zaremba, Durk Kingma, Pamela Vagata, Vicki Cheung

Source: Tracxn company profile; OpenAI corporate records (public).

3. Corporate Structure

OpenAI's for-profit arm now operates as a public benefit corporation, OpenAI Group PBC, which is legally required to advance its stated mission and weigh the interests of all stakeholders, not just shareholders. The nonprofit OpenAI Foundation retains control of OpenAI Group and holds conventional equity in it, meaning all stockholders participate proportionally in value growth.

Analytical note: this structure is a deliberate hybrid — it allows OpenAI to raise large amounts of investor capital (like a normal company) while nominally preserving mission-based governance through the Foundation's controlling position.

Source: openai.com/our-structure

4. Financials & Funding Timeline

- Dec 2015 — First funding round (Seed).

- Apr 2025 — \$40B raised at a \$300B post-money valuation, led by SoftBank; other participants included Microsoft, Coatue, Altimeter, and Thrive.
- Jul 2025 — Annualized revenue reported at \$12B, up from \$3.7B in 2024; 20M paid ChatGPT subscribers.
- Feb 27, 2026 — \$110B raised at a \$730B pre-money valuation (\$840B post-money), led by Amazon (\$50B), Nvidia (\$30B), and SoftBank (\$30B) — the largest private funding round in history at the time.
- Mar 31, 2026 — Round closed at \$122B total committed capital, post-money valuation \$852B; extended to individual investors for the first time (~\$3B raised via bank channels); Microsoft also participated (amount undisclosed).
- Jun 8, 2026 — OpenAI confirmed it confidentially filed for an IPO with the SEC; no timeline disclosed.

Revenue & scale: OpenAI reports roughly \$2B in monthly revenue and \$13.1B in revenue for the prior fiscal year, but remains unprofitable, with continued high cash burn driven by compute costs.

Sources: *OpenAI official announcement (openai.com); CNBC; Wikipedia; Tracxn; PitchBook.*

5. Products & Market Scale

- ChatGPT: surpassed 900 million weekly active users; over 50 million paying Plus/Pro subscribers.
- Enterprise: over 9 million paying business users; enterprise now exceeds 40% of revenue and is approaching parity with consumer revenue.
- API: processing more than 15 billion tokens per minute.
- Codex (coding product): over 2 million weekly users, up 5x in three months, growing 70%+ month-over-month.

Source: *OpenAI official funding announcement, openai.com (April 2026).*

6. Leadership & Governance Timeline

- Sep 2024 — CTO Mira Murati departs the company.
- Nov 2025 — Board member Lawrence Summers resigns.
- Apr 2026 — Fidji Simo (Head of AGI Deployment) takes several weeks of medical leave, triggering a leadership reshuffle: Brad Lightcap moves from COO to lead "special projects" reporting directly to Sam Altman; CRO Denise Dresser temporarily absorbs operational duties; Greg Brockman takes over the product organization.

Source: *Wikipedia (OpenAI), citing contemporary reporting.*

7. Legal & Reputational Signals

- Jul 2023 — Sued for copyright infringement by authors Sarah Silverman, Matthew Butterick, Paul Tremblay, and Mona Awad.
- Pre-May 2024 — Required departing employees to sign lifelong non-disparagement agreements; after public pressure (notably from former employee Daniel Kokotajlo, who forfeited vested equity to avoid signing), OpenAI released former employees from the agreement in May 2024.
- Early 2026 — Provided the entire initial funding for the "Parents & Kids Safe AI Coalition"; several contacted organizations reportedly were unaware of OpenAI's involvement, raising questions about undisclosed influence.

Source: *Wikipedia (OpenAI), public reporting.*

8. Competitive Landscape

Public company-intelligence databases list OpenAI's primary competitors as Anthropic, Mistral AI, Cohere, and DeepSeek, among others, within the generative AI and AI infrastructure sectors.

Source: Tracxn, PitchBook.

9. Intelligence Assessment

Applying the intelligence cycle to convert the information above into intelligence:

- **Capital position:** Despite record-breaking fundraising (\$852B valuation), OpenAI is still not profitable and carries heavy, escalating compute-driven spending commitments (projected ~\$115B through 2029) — suggesting continued dependence on investor capital rather than self-sustaining cash flow.
- **Leadership stability:** Multiple senior departures and an April 2026 reshuffle following a leave of absence suggest some organizational strain beneath the growth headlines, though core leadership (Altman, Brockman) remains intact.
- **Governance design:** The Foundation-controlled PBC structure appears engineered to balance investor demands for scale against public mission commitments — a detail likely to matter for regulatory and IPO scrutiny.
- **Public trust exposure:** The undisclosed funding of a child-safety coalition and historical non-disparagement controversy both point to a recurring pattern worth monitoring: reputational risk from insufficient transparency, even amid strong commercial performance.

10. Source List

- openai.com — official corporate announcements and structure page
- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/OpenAI — aggregated public reporting and timeline
- tracxn.com — company/funding profile
- pitchbook.com — company/funding profile
- cnbc.com — financial news reporting

Methodology note: This report was compiled exclusively from open, publicly accessible sources (company statements, news reporting, and public company-data aggregators). No private, proprietary, or unauthorized-access information was used.